DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 4

Shopify developer

Profession 4 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A Shopify developer builds and customises online shops on Shopify, a hosted e-commerce platform. The work covers themes (built with Liquid), apps, product data, checkout settings and integrations with payments, shipping and accounting.

What professionals do every day

Customises theme sections, sets up products and collections, installs and configures apps, connects payments and shipping, tests checkout, and fixes storefront issues.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Merchants want to sell without running servers. A Shopify developer makes the store look right, load fast, and handle the business rules (discounts, bundles, delivery areas) that the basic theme cannot.

- Stores that look generic or load slowly.
- Manual order and stock work that an integration can automate.
- Checkout and shipping rules that a standard setup does not cover.

Skills you need

- E-commerce basics: products, variants, collections, orders, taxes.
- HTML, CSS and JavaScript; Liquid templating.
- Shopify admin, theme editor and apps.
- Performance and accessibility of storefronts.
- Basic integrations (APIs and webhooks, see Part 1 Module B).

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Shopify	E-commerce platform	Free trial and development stores through the official programme	Paid plans	www.shopify.com
Shopify Dev Docs	Theme and app developer reference	Free	Free	shopify.dev
Shopify CLI	Command-line tool for theme development	Free	Free	shopify.dev/docs/apps/tools/cli
Shopify Partners	Partner programme with development stores	Free to join	Free to join	www.shopify.com/partners

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish

Beginner	Admin setup, products, collections, discounts; edit an existing theme's text and images.
Intermediate	Theme sections with Liquid and schema; install and configure one app; test checkout in a development store.
Advanced	Custom app integrations with the Admin API, webhooks, performance audits and multi-currency or multi-region setup.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** A store for one product category with a custom homepage section.
- **Intermediate:** A bundle or discount rule set up with an app and tested.
- **Advanced:** An integration that syncs orders to a spreadsheet or CRM.

Client-ready portfolio project

A complete store for a fictional or permissioned business: theme customisation, product catalogue, shipping and tax set up according to official guidance, and a checkout test log.

Worked example

Worked example. Adding a 'Free delivery over Rs 500' banner: create a text section in the theme editor, write the condition in a shipping rule, and test one cart above and one below the threshold.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

A featured-products section for a bakery store

Business problem: The bakery owner wants a homepage section that shows three bestsellers from a chosen collection, with a heading the owner can edit.

Steps

1. Create a development store from the Shopify Partners programme or a trial account (official sign-up page).
2. Add a collection named 'Bestsellers' and three products with images and prices.
3. Create the file `sections/featured-products.liquid` as in the solution.
4. Add the section to the homepage in the theme editor and set the heading and collection.
5. Check the page on a phone and a laptop.

Expected output: A homepage section that shows three products with image, title and price, editable in the theme editor.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The Liquid loop reads the products from the chosen collection and limits the output to three. The schema block tells the theme editor which settings to show, so the owner can change the heading and collection without touching code. `loading="lazy"` delays off-screen images, which helps speed. **Not run here:** this needs a Shopify store, which was not reachable from this session; check the current Liquid and schema reference in the Shopify developer documentation before publishing.

LIQUID

```liquid
{%- comment -%} sections/featured-products.liquid (simplified) {%- endcomment -%}
<section class="featured">
  <h2>{{ section.settings.heading }}</h2>
  <div class="grid">
    {%- for product in collections[section.settings.collection].products limit: 3 -%}
      <article class="card">
        <a href="{{ product.url }}">
          <img src="{{ product.featured_image | image_url: width: 600 }}" alt="{{
product.featured_image.alt | escape }}" loading="lazy">
          <h3>{{ product.title }}</h3>
        </a>
        <p>{{ product.price | money }}</p>
      </article>
    {%- endfor -%}
  </div>
</section>
{% schema %}
{ "name": "Featured products", "settings": [
  { "type": "text", "id": "heading", "label": "Heading", "default": "Our bestsellers" },
  { "type": "collection", "id": "collection", "label": "Collection" } ],
  "presets": [{ "name": "Featured products" }] }
{% endschema %}
```

Common mistakes

- Editing the live store before testing in a development store.
- Installing many apps that slow the store and conflict with each other.
- Forgetting to set tax and shipping rules for each region.
- Copying third-party themes without a licence.

Freelancing opportunities

- Store setup and redesign for small brands.
- Monthly maintenance (app updates, new products, banners).
- Integrations for order and stock sync; search 'Shopify', 'Liquid', 'Shopify app' on freelance marketplaces.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Shopify theme development docs
- Shopify API documentation
- Shopify Help Centre

Part of **Master Freelancing: Development and IT**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.